



Orthognathic Surgery: Upper Jaw (Maxillary Osteotomy)

Purpose: Surgical repositioning of the upper jaw to correct bite problems, facial asymmetry, or airway issues.

First 24–48 Hours:

- Swelling and bruising will be significant, peaking at 48–72 hours.
- Apply ice packs externally for 20 minutes at a time during the first 48 hours.
- Keep your head elevated when resting to minimize swelling.
- Avoid spitting, rinsing, or using straws for the first 24 hours.

Pain & Sensitivity:

- Take prescribed pain medications as directed.
- Temporary numbness or tingling in the cheeks, lips, or nose is common.

Oral Hygiene:

- Use a prescribed antimicrobial rinse as directed.
- Brush teeth gently with a soft toothbrush, avoiding surgical sites.
- An irrigation syringe may be provided to keep the surgical area clean.

Diet:

- Follow a liquid or pureed diet for the initial healing phase.
- Do not chew until your surgeon gives clearance.

Special Precautions:

- Avoid strenuous activity for at least 2 weeks.
- Do not smoke or drink alcohol while healing.
- Elastic bands or fixation devices may be used; follow instructions carefully.

Follow-Up:

- Attend all post-op appointments for monitoring and adjustments.
- Call the office if you experience sudden swelling, high fever, difficulty breathing, or signs of infection.